English learning *resources*

The tools and habits I recommend to my students

The more English you speak, hear, and read, the better for your brain. A little every week does more than a lot once in a while, so pick the things you actually enjoy and start there!

01 Keep speaking

I can't stress this enough: speak as often as you can. Language exchange apps like **HelloTalk** and **Tandem** give you people to practise with, and small talk is the easiest place to start.

Small talk starter kit

For the British, small talk is practically a national sport. A couple of minutes of it warms everyone up and gets you speaking English before the difficult part starts.

START

'How's your week going so far?'

'Did you get up to anything nice at the weekend?'

'What's the weather like where you are?' (a classic for a reason)

KEEP IT GOING (ARC)

Acknowledge 'Oh, that sounds lovely.'

Respond 'Same here, actually. I...'

Continue 'What about you?'

MOVE ON

'Right, shall we make a start?'

'Anyway, I'll let you get on.'

'It was lovely to chat.'

02 Listen and watch

Podcasts, films, and TV count as study too, and they're far more fun. If English TV feels hard, start with subtitles and slowly stop using them. You're listening for the gist, not every single word. If you only have a few minutes, **English Addict with Mr Duncan** has short videos on everyday topics and vocabulary.

All Ears English
A podcast in American English, on the English you need for real conversations

Luke's English Podcast
A podcast in British English, by a London teacher who is also a stand-up comedian

The English We Speak
A BBC Learning English podcast that explains one everyday phrase in about three minutes

TED Talks Daily
A podcast with a new TED talk every weekday, on anything from AI to zoology

03 Build your vocabulary

Read about things you're already interested in, and you'll pick up the expressions you actually need. **BBC News** is a good place to start. If the news feels too difficult, **News in Levels** lets you choose your level and work your way up.

Tip: aim for 5–10 new expressions a week, formal or idiomatic, and use them in conversation. **Quizlet** lets you make your own flashcards for them.

04 Check your grammar

English Page and **Perfect English Grammar** both have clear explanations, with exercises to practise.

05 Learn with me

All of my courses are for B2+ level, and they run online, apart from the retreat. If you've enjoyed my method, take a look, or share them with a friend. I'd love to see you around!

Unlock English Fluency
5 DAYS, 6 HOURS A DAY

My intensive course. Speak spontaneously and share your opinions with confidence.

Maintain Fluency
8 WEEKS, 2 HOURS A WEEK

An evening course to keep your English active and your confidence growing.

Weekend Boost
4 WEEKENDS, 2 HOURS A DAY

Relaxed, practical speaking practice to refresh your English.

News Unlocked
4 WEEKS, 2 HOURS A WEEK

Talk about the week's news in confident, professional English.

Book Club
4 WEEKS, 2 HOURS A WEEK

Read a novel together, talk about it, and pick up new vocabulary.

Summer Retreat in Cambridge
5 DAYS, IN CAMBRIDGE

A week of intensive training and a classic Cambridge experience.

Stay in touch

Join my WhatsApp community to stay in touch with me and get a new resource every fortnight: English words, idioms, and the stories behind them.

Join on WhatsApp

I hope you find these resources useful!

Christina

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